5-Minute Mystery Shopper Script

Park: _____ **Date:** _____

Part A: Before you fall for anything.

Takes in: the package's claims.

Hands to: AS-05, AS-15 or AS-15R.

The seller says 95% occupied with a waitlist. One five-minute call tells you if that is true.

1. Before you dial: circle your track

- ☐ Track 1: RV. Nightly, monthly, or seasonal stay.
- ☐ Track 2: MHC. A lot for your own home.
- ☐ Track 3: MHC. A home rental or purchase.
- ☐ Pull the advertised rate from the broker package and write it down.
- ☐ Note the claimed occupancy and any waitlist claim, word for word.
- ☐ Call mid-morning on a weekday, from a number the seller does not know.

2. The script: run your track, all eight questions

Track 1: RV

1. "Hi, I'm looking for a site for my RV. Do you have any spots open right now?"
2. "What's the nightly rate, and what does that include?"
3. "Do you offer monthly or seasonal rates? What do those run?"
4. "Are utilities included, or do guests pay electric and water separately?"
5. "Is there a deposit or reservation fee to hold a site?"
6. "What are the park rules I should know about? Pets, vehicles, visitors?"
7. "If I booked today, how soon could I get a site?"
8. "Thanks, what's your name? I'll call back once I've decided."

Track 2: MHC, lot for your own home

1. "Hi, I'm looking for a lot for my own manufactured home. Any lots open right now?"
2. "What's the monthly lot rent, and what does that include?"
3. "Are utilities included, or do tenants pay electric and water separately?"
4. "Is there an application fee or a deposit to move in?"
5. "What are the park rules I should know about? Pets, vehicles, visitors?"
6. "I heard there might be a waitlist. Is that real, and how long is it?"
7. "If I applied today, how soon could I move in?"
8. "Thanks, what's your name? I'll call back once I've decided."

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Track 3: MHC, home rental or purchase

1. "Hi, do you have any homes for rent in the park right now?"
2. "What's the monthly rent, and what does that include?"
3. "Are utilities included, or do tenants pay electric and water separately?"
4. "Is there an application fee or a deposit to move in?"
5. "What are the park rules I should know about? Pets, vehicles, visitors?"
6. "Do you ever sell homes in the park, or is it rentals only?"
7. "If I applied today, how soon could I move in?"
8. "Thanks, what's your name? I'll call back once I've decided."

3. Scoring box

	Package says	They said	Match?
Quoted rent or rate			Y / N
Availability vs claimed occupancy			Y / N
Waitlist: real or not			Y / N
Rules and fees mentioned			Y / N
Condition matches package photos			0 / 1 / 2

Condition scores 0 if the drive-by looks nothing like the photos, 1 if it mostly matches, 2 if it matches.

4. What a mismatch means

- Rent lower than the package: a pricing question, not fraud. Ask why the package shows more.
- Open lots but they claim 95%+: occupancy is padded. Verify with bank deposits.
- No waitlist exists: demand is softer than claimed. Reprice on real occupancy.
- Fees or rules never mentioned in the package: the fine print was hidden. Ask what else is missing.
- Park looks rough on the drive-by: condition problems the photos skipped. Walk every lot.

One mismatch is a question. Three is a pattern. Patterns get priced in or walked away from.

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Worked example: Pine Hollow, RV track

Fictional example. Seeds from the Pine Hollow running case. Package claims: 37 transient sites, 45% annual occupancy, $48 ADR, 18 long-stay at $600 a month.

Score each answer: 2 if it confirms the package, 1 if the package was silent on it, 0 if it contradicts the package. Max 16.

Q	Package claim	They said	Score
1	45% transient occupancy	"Several open tonight."	2
2	$48 ADR	"$48 rack; we discount to fill weekends."	0
3	$600/mo long-stay	"$600 for the monthly sites."	2
4	(package silent)	"Guests pay electric; water included."	1
5	(package silent)	"$50 plus first night to hold."	1
6	(package silent)	"Dogs on leash, 40-foot max, no tents."	1
7	45% occupancy, sites open	"Today if you want one."	2
8	(package silent)	"Ask for Dana."	1

Total: 2 + 0 + 2 + 1 + 1 + 1 + 2 + 1 = 10 of 16. One outright mismatch (Q2), four questions. Not a pattern, so the call passes. But Q2 routes to the revenue bridge: the discount habit is exactly what the AS-15R bridge later proves, realized ADR $34.64 against the $48 rack. Q4 (utilities) routes to the expense normalizer.

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Doctrine

Doctrine: the package is a sales document, and every sales document rounds up. The belief this shatters: that the seller's numbers are the starting point and your job is to adjust them. They are not. Your job is to observe independently and price the pattern. The one rule: one mismatch is a question, three is a pattern, and a pattern is either priced in or walked away from. A five-minute call is the cheapest diligence dollar you will ever spend. It costs five minutes and tells you whether the next fifty hours of diligence are worth anything.

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